

A SEVEN-DAY RETREAT IN DAILY LIFE

Come and See

Seven encounters with Jesus · World English Bible (public domain) · public-domain paintings

Day 1. Follow Me · Mark 1:16-20

Day 2. He Rose and Followed · Matthew 9:9-13

Day 3. Living Water · John 4:7-15

Day 4. Why Are You Afraid? · Mark 4:35-41

Day 5. Welcomed Home · Luke 15:17-24

Day 6. Called by Name · John 20:11-18

Day 7. Our Hearts Burning · Luke 24:28-35

How to pray this week

This week is a small retreat in daily life: seven times of prayer, one a day, each with a moment when someone meets Jesus in the Gospels. Two fishermen at their nets. A tax collector at his table. A woman at a well at noon. Frightened friends in a boat. A son on the road home. A woman weeping at a tomb. Two travelers at supper.

Each day, find a quiet place and about half an hour. Become aware that God is already present. Ask for the grace named for the day, plainly, as something you want. Read the passage slowly, more than once. Let the painting help you enter the scene: where are you standing, what do you see and hear, who looks at you? Notice what stirs in you, peace or resistance, desire or fear, and stay with the word or image that holds you. End by speaking to Jesus in your own words, as one friend speaks to another, and close with the Our Father.

On the seventh day, return to the day that moved you most.

DAY 1

Day 1: Follow Me

Mark 1:16-20

Grace: Ask for the grace to hear Jesus call me where I am, and to leave behind whatever keeps me from following him.

Passing along by the sea of Galilee, he saw Simon and Andrew the brother of Simon casting a net into the sea, for they were fishermen. Jesus said to them, “Come after me, and I will make you into fishers for men.” Immediately they left their nets, and followed him. Going on a little further from there, he saw James the son of Zebedee, and John, his brother, who were also in the boat mending the nets. Immediately he called them, and they left their father, Zebedee, in the boat with the hired servants, and went after him.



Duccio di Buoninsegna, The Calling of the Apostles Peter and Andrew, 1308-1311. National Gallery of Art, Washington. Public domain,

via Wikimedia Commons.

DAY 2

Day 2: He Rose and Followed

Matthew 9:9-13

Grace: Ask for the grace to know that Jesus calls me as I am, with all my history, and to rise and follow him.

As Jesus passed by from there, he saw a man called Matthew sitting at the tax collection office. He said to him, “Follow me.” He got up and followed him. As he sat in the house, behold, many tax collectors and sinners came and sat down with Jesus and his disciples. When the Pharisees saw it, they said to his disciples, “Why does your teacher eat with tax collectors and sinners?” When Jesus heard it, he said to them, “Those who are healthy have no need for a physician, but those who are sick do. But you go and learn what this means: ‘I desire mercy, and not sacrifice,’ for I came not to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance.”



Caravaggio, The Calling of Saint Matthew, 1599-1600. San Luigi dei Francesi, Rome. Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons.

DAY 3

Day 3: Living Water

John 4:7-15

Grace: Ask for the grace to recognize my deepest thirst, and to receive the living water Jesus offers.

A woman of Samaria came to draw water. Jesus said to her, “Give me a drink.” For his disciples had gone away into the city to buy food. The Samaritan woman therefore said to him, “How is it that you, being a Jew, ask for a drink from me, a Samaritan woman?” (For Jews have no dealings with Samaritans.) Jesus answered her, “If you knew the gift of God, and who it is who says to you, ‘Give me a drink,’ you would have asked him, and he would have given you living water.” The woman said to him, “Sir, you have nothing to draw with, and the well is deep. So where do you get that living water? Are you greater than our father, Jacob, who gave us the well, and drank of it himself, as did his children, and his livestock?” Jesus answered her, “Everyone who drinks of this water will thirst again, but whoever drinks of the water that I will give him will never thirst again; but the water that I will give him will become in him a well of water springing up to eternal life.” The woman said to him, “Sir, give me this water, so that I don’t get thirsty, neither come all the way here to draw.”



Carl Bloch, Woman at the Well, 19th century. Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons.

DAY 4

Day 4: Why Are You Afraid?

Mark 4:35-41

Grace: Ask for the grace to trust Jesus in the storms of my life, even when he seems to be asleep.

On that day, when evening had come, he said to them, “Let’s go over to the other side.” Leaving the multitude, they took him with them, even as he was, in the boat. Other small boats were also with him. A big wind storm arose, and the waves beat into the boat, so much that the boat was already filled. He himself was in the stern, asleep on the cushion, and they woke him up, and told him, “Teacher, don’t you care that we are dying?” He awoke, and rebuked the wind, and said to the sea, “Peace! Be still!” The wind ceased, and there was a great calm. He said to them, “Why are you so afraid? How is it that you have no faith?” They were greatly afraid, and said to one another, “Who then is this, that even the wind and the sea obey him?”



Rembrandt, Christ in the Storm on the Sea of Galilee, 1633. Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons.

DAY 5

Day 5: Welcomed Home

Luke 15:17-24

Grace: Ask for the grace to come home, and to let the Father embrace me before I finish my apology.

But when he came to himself he said, ‘How many hired servants of my father’s have bread enough to spare, and I’m dying with hunger! I will get up and go to my father, and will tell him, “Father, I have sinned against heaven, and in your sight. I am no more worthy to be called your son. Make me as one of your hired servants.”’ “He arose, and came to his father. But while he was still far off, his father saw him, and was moved with compassion, and ran, and fell on his neck, and kissed him. The son said to him, ‘Father, I have sinned against heaven, and in your sight. I am no longer worthy to be called your son.’ “But the father said to his servants, ‘Bring out the best robe, and put it on him. Put a ring on his hand, and shoes on his feet. Bring the fattened calf, kill it, and let us eat, and celebrate; for this, my son, was dead, and is alive again. He was lost, and is found.’ They began to celebrate.



Rembrandt, The Return of the Prodigal Son, about 1668. State Hermitage Museum, Saint Petersburg. Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons.

DAY 6

Day 6: Called by Name

John 20:11-18

Grace: Ask for the grace to hear the risen Jesus call me by name, and to go and tell what I have seen.

But Mary was standing outside at the tomb weeping. So, as she wept, she stooped and looked into the tomb, and she saw two angels in white sitting, one at the head, and one at the feet, where the body of Jesus had lain. They told her, “Woman, why are you weeping?” She said to them, “Because they have taken away my Lord, and I don’t know where they have laid him.” When she had said this, she turned around and saw Jesus standing, and didn’t know that it was Jesus. Jesus said to her, “Woman, why are you weeping? Who are you looking for?” She, supposing him to be the gardener, said to him, “Sir, if you have carried him away, tell me where you have laid him, and I will take him away.” Jesus said to her, “Mary.” She turned and said to him, “Rabboni!” which is to say, “Teacher!” Jesus said to her, “Don’t hold me, for I haven’t yet ascended to my Father; but go to my brothers, and tell them, ‘I am ascending to my Father and your Father, to my God and your God.’” Mary Magdalene came and told the disciples that she had seen the Lord, and that he had said these things to her.



Titian, Noli me Tangere, about 1514. National Gallery, London. Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons.

DAY 7

Day 7: Our Hearts Burning

Luke 24:28-35

Grace: Ask for the grace to recognize Jesus in the breaking of the bread, and to feel my heart burn within me.

They came near to the village, where they were going, and he acted like he would go further. They urged him, saying, “Stay with us, for it is almost evening, and the day is almost over.” He went in to stay with them. When he had sat down at the table with them, he took the bread and gave thanks. Breaking it, he gave it to them. Their eyes were opened, and they recognized him, and he vanished out of their sight. They said to one another, “Weren’t our hearts burning within us, while he spoke to us along the way, and while he opened the Scriptures to us?” They rose up that very hour, returned to Jerusalem, and found the eleven gathered together, and those who were with them, saying, “The Lord is risen indeed, and has appeared to Simon!” They related the things that happened along the way, and how he was recognized by them in the breaking of the bread.



Caravaggio, Supper at Emmaus, 1601. National Gallery, London. Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons.

Credits

Scripture: World English Bible, public domain.

Day 1: Duccio di Buoninsegna, The Calling of the Apostles Peter and Andrew, 1308-1311. National Gallery of Art, Washington.

Day 2: Caravaggio, The Calling of Saint Matthew, 1599-1600. San Luigi dei Francesi, Rome.

Day 3: Carl Bloch, Woman at the Well, 19th century.

Day 4: Rembrandt, Christ in the Storm on the Sea of Galilee, 1633.

Day 5: Rembrandt, The Return of the Prodigal Son, about 1668. State Hermitage Museum, Saint Petersburg.

Day 6: Titian, Noli me Tangere, about 1514. National Gallery, London.

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